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READING NOTES

This issue ties portraiture to Symbolism and Surrealist image logic. Symbolism supports the inward state: the visible surface carries pressure beyond literal description. Surrealist interruption supports the delayed reading of veils, fragments, and displaced features.

The human gaze is treated as behavior before style. Eye direction, obstruction, and repetition guide attention, shape expectation, and make the viewer aware of how quickly a face becomes a psychological event.

Women through time are approached as a visual history of roles and thresholds: origin, mother, worker, witness, symbol, and self-possessed subject. The emphasis is perception and representation, not a single political claim.